

FOR PRINCIPALS & SUPERINTENDENTS · 3-MINUTE READ

AI for Planning & Differentiation

A 45–60 minute session in which every teacher differentiates a real upcoming lesson: core, support, and extension versions, taught that week. Run by your own coach; no consultant required.

Why this matters now

Differentiation has research behind it: a meta-analysis (Deunk et al., 2018) found positive effects, strongest when embedded in instruction and supported by technology. What it never had was a sustainable cost: three versions of everything by hand. That cost just collapsed: 61% of teachers now use AI in their work (EdWeek Research Center, 2026), and most who use it for a given task say it saves them time (Gallup & Walton Family Foundation, 2025). A verification habit is attached: a peer-reviewed study (PLOS ONE, 2024) showed ChatGPT drafting a standards-aligned lesson in about 30 minutes while inserting flaws and a fabricated resource, so teacher review is built into every step.

What your staff will be able to do afterward

- Run the planning workflow: draft, options, pick, review; never from a blank page again
- Use four differentiation moves with copy-ready prompts: level it, scaffold it, stretch it, reformat it
- Verify AI-leveled texts instead of trusting the label
- Apply a 4-point review (accurate · at level · fits · sounds like you) before anything reaches a student
- Own one fully differentiated artifact for a lesson taught this week
- Sustain a one-artifact-per-week habit through three 10-minute PLC follow-ups

The equity angle

RAND (2025) found 25% of teachers used AI for planning or teaching in 2023–24, with higher-poverty schools lagging: exactly where differentiation help bites hardest. Whole-staff training plus a shared prompt library makes these tools narrow gaps instead of widening them.

Research base in brief

Differentiation effects: Deunk et al. (2018) · UDL frame: CAST UDL Guidelines 3.0 (2024) · AI lesson-drafting evidence and limits: Powell & Courchesne, PLOS ONE (2024) · Adoption & time data: EdWeek Research Center (2026); Gallup–Walton Family Foundation (2025); RAND RR-A134-25 (2025). Full APA citations ship in the kit's References file.

Where it fits

Kit 3 of 8 in **Track A: AI Foundations**, after Kit 1 (safety) and Kit 2 (prompting). Ships with a 30-day plan and an exit ticket that doubles as PD documentation. Zero student data anywhere: needs are described generically, never by name.

Built by Adam & Katelyn Spinozzi, certified educators. © AI-Ready School. Informational, not legal advice; consult district counsel. Check with your district or state whether this PD qualifies for local credit.